

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

----- X
VANTZ ELIANOR,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NYPD POLICE SERGEANT
ROBERT MAYER, Shield No. 18638, NYPD POLICE
OFFICER ANTHONY ORLANDO, Shield No. 9744,
NYPD POLICE OFFICER JUNG SINGH, Shield No.
30788, and NYPD POLICE OFFICERS JOHN/JANE
DOES NUMBERS ONE THROUGH TEN,

Defendants.
----- X

SUMMONS

Index No.:

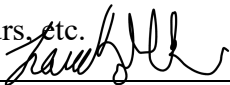
The Basis of Venue is:
Location of Incident

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Verified Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your Verified Answer to the Verified Complaint, or, if the Verified Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorneys within twenty days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

DATED: New York, New York
March 7, 2023

Yours, etc. 

Lara Belkin, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 203-1090

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

NYPD POLICE SERGEANT ROBERT MAYER, Shield No. 18638, 81st Precinct, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

NYPD POLICE OFFICER ANTHONY ORLANDO, SHIELD 9744, 81st Precinct, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

NYPD POLICE OFFICER JUNG SINGH, SHIELD NO. 30788, 81st Precinct, 30 Ralph Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

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INDEX NO.:**VERIFIED COMPLAINT****JURY TRIAL DEMANDED**

Plaintiff VANTZ ELIANOR, by his attorneys, Shulman-Hill, PLLC, as and for his Verified Complaint herein, alleges upon information and belief as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

This is a civil rights action to recover money damages arising out of defendants' violation of Plaintiff's rights as secured by the Civil Rights Act, 42 U.S.C. Sections 1983 and 1988, and of rights secured by the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, and the common law and the laws of the State of New York. On February 7, 2022, at approximately 12:55 a.m., Plaintiff Vantz Elianor was subjected to an unlawful arrest and detention by defendant Police Officers. In addition, Plaintiff was subjected to approximately seven (7) days of unlawful confinement, first at the NYPD 81st Precinct and Kings County Central Booking, and finally at Rikers Island Correctional Facility. The unlawful arrest caused Plaintiff to miss eight days of work and exposed him to various injuries and harm while he was incarcerated at Rikers Island. On August 16, 2022, all criminal charges against Plaintiff were dismissed and sealed. Plaintiff was deprived of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802 and his constitutional, common law and statutory rights when the individual defendants unlawfully stopped and detained him, passed along false accusations to prosecuting attorneys and engaged in the malicious prosecution of Plaintiff, in violation of the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, the common law and the laws of the State of New York.

PARTIES

1. Plaintiff Vantz Elianor is a resident of the state of New York.
2. New York City Police Sergeant Robert Mayer, Shield No. 18638, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.
3. New York City Police Sergeant Robert Mayer, Shield No. 18638, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.
4. Currently and at all times relevant herein, New York City Police Sergeant Robert Mayer, Shield No. 18638, was assigned to the 81st Precinct of the NYPD.
5. New York City Police Officer Anthony Orlando, Shield No. 9744, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.
6. New York City Police Officer Anthony Orlando, Shield No. 9744, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.
7. Currently and at all times relevant herein, New York City Police Officer Anthony Orlando, Shield No. 9744, was assigned to the 81st Precinct of the NYPD.
8. New York City Police Officer Jung Singh, Shield No. 30788, is and was at all times relevant herein an Officer with the New York City Police Department.
9. New York City Police Officer Jung Singh, Shield No. 30788, is being sued in their individual and official capacity.
10. Currently and at all times relevant herein, New York City Police Officer Jung Singh, Shield No. 30788, was assigned to the 81st Precinct of the NYPD.
11. New York City Police Officers John/Jane Does #1-10 are and were at all times relevant herein officers, employees, and agents of the New York City Police Department.
12. Police Officers John/Jane Does #1-10 are being sued in their individual and official capacities.
13. At all times relevant herein, the individual defendants were acting under color of state law in the course and scope of their duties and functions as agents, servants, employees and officers of the New York City Police Department, and otherwise performed and engaged in conduct incidental to the performance of their lawful functions in the course of their duties. They were acting for and on behalf of the New York City Police Department at all times relevant herein, with the power and authority vested in them as officers, agents and employees of the New York City Police Department and incidental to the lawful pursuit of their duties as officers, employees and agents of the New York City Police Department.

14. Defendant City of New York is a municipal entity created and authorized under the laws of the State of New York. It is authorized by law to maintain a police department, which acts as its agent in the area of law enforcement and for which it is ultimately responsible. The defendant City of New York assumes the risks incidental to the maintenance of a police force and the employment of police officers as said risks attach to the public consumers of the services provided by the New York City Police Department.

15. Plaintiff in furtherance of his causes of action brought pursuant to New York State law filed a timely Notice of Claim against the City of New York in compliance with the Municipal Law Section 50 and in accordance with New York State law.

16. In accordance with New York State law and General Municipal Law Section 50, Plaintiff testified at a hearing held pursuant to General Municipal Law Section 50-H on January 5, 2023.

17. More than thirty (30) days have elapsed since service of said Notice of Claim was filed and the City of New York has failed to pay or adjust the claims.

18. This action falls within one or more of the exceptions as set forth in CPLR Section 1602, involving intentional actions, as well as the defendant, and/or defendants, having acted in reckless disregard for the safety of others, as well as having performed intentional acts.

19. Plaintiff has sustained damages in an amount in excess of the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts of the State of New York.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

20. On February 7, 2022, at approximately 12:55 a.m., Plaintiff was lawfully in the vicinity of 2008 Fulton Street, the building in which he rented a room, in Kings County, New York, when defendant Police Officers unlawfully arrested and detained Plaintiff without legal justification.

21. On the morning of February 6, 2022, Plaintiff was returning to his residence at approximately 9:00 am, when he encountered Defendant Police Officers, who denied Plaintiff entry to his home and ordered him to remain outside, absent any probable cause or reasonable suspicion.

22. Plaintiff asked to see a warrant and defendant officers refused to show him a warrant or provide any legal justification as to why he could not enter his residence.

23. Nonetheless, Plaintiff obeyed defendant officers' unlawful orders and remained outside for the entire day while defendant officers blocked entry to his home.

24. Finally, at some point in the evening, defendant officers searched the entire building, while Plaintiff remained outside.

25. Despite the fact that Plaintiff had not engaged in any illegal behavior or even been present during the search of the building, Plaintiff was placed in a police vehicle and transported to the 81st Precinct.

26. At the 81st Precinct, Plaintiff was put in a holding cell in handcuffs.

27. At no point did Plaintiff resist this unlawful arrest in any way.

28. Plaintiff had not engaged in any unlawful conduct and had no idea why he was being arrested.

29. While plaintiff was in custody, defendant officers knowingly transmitted false information to the Brooklyn District Attorney's office, including allegations that Plaintiff had committed certain crimes.

30. At approximately 4:00 a.m. on February 8, 2022, Plaintiff was transferred to Central Booking where he was again placed in a holding cell.

31. Plaintiff remained at Central Booking until 7:00 p.m. on February 9, 2022, when he was brought to court for his arraignment.

32. Plaintiff was appointed an attorney at his arraignment who informed him that he was being charged with criminal possession of a weapon in the third degree and related charges.

33. At his arraignment, due to the false allegations of defendant officers that Plaintiff was in unlawful possession of a weapon and the charges based on those allegations, bail was set for Plaintiff in the amount of \$50,000. Plaintiff could not pay bail and was sent to Rikers Island.

34. Plaintiff remained incarcerated at Rikers Island until February 14, 2022, when he was released after prosecutors failed to secure an indictment against him.

35. Plaintiff made approximately five subsequent in-person court appearances before the charges were dismissed and sealed on August 16, 2022.

36. At no time relevant herein did Plaintiff commit a crime or violate the law in any way, nor did the police officers have an objective, credible reason to accuse Plaintiff of committing a crime or violating the law in any way.

37. At no point did Defendant Officers recover any drugs, weapons, graffiti instruments, or other illegal contraband from Plaintiff's person or from a location that was in Plaintiff's possession, custody, or control.

38. Nevertheless, Plaintiff was unlawfully arrested and handcuffed by defendant officers without legal justification or probable cause, unlawfully fingerprinted, photographed and searched, and unlawfully detained.

39. Plaintiff's spurious prosecution was based on the unlawful actions of defendant officers.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Stop, Question, and Search

40. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

41. The illegal approach, stop and detention of Plaintiff employed by defendants herein terminated Plaintiff's freedom of movement through means intentionally applied.

42. The conduct of defendants in approaching, stopping, and grabbing Plaintiff was performed under color of law and without any reasonable suspicion of criminality or other constitutionally required grounds.

43. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

44. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

45. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Unlawful Seizure and Deprivation of Liberty

46. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

47. The individually named police officer defendants, while acting in concert and within the scope of their authority, caused Plaintiff to be seized, falsely arrested, and falsely imprisoned, and maliciously prosecuted without reasonable suspicion and/or probable cause, in violation of Plaintiff's right to be free of an unreasonable seizure under the Fourth Amendment of the Constitution of the United States and to be free of a deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States.

48. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
False Imprisonment

49. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

50. The acts and conduct of the defendants constitute false arrest and false imprisonment under the laws of the State of New York. Defendants intended to confine Plaintiff and, in fact, confined Plaintiff, and Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement. In addition, Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement and the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

51. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York and the United States Constitution.

52. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

53. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondent superior*.

54. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to loss of liberty, emotional and psychological injuries.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligence

55. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

56. Defendants owed a duty of care to Plaintiff.

57. To the extent defendants claim that the injuries to Plaintiff by the Defendant Police Officers was unintentionally caused and that the force used by the defendants against him was unintentional, then the defendants breached that duty of care by injuring his wrists.

58. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

59. All of the foregoing occurred without any fault or provocation by Plaintiff.

60. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

61. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

62. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Infliction of Emotional Distress

63. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

64. By the actions described herein, defendants, each acting individually and in concert with each other, engaged in extreme and outrageous conduct, conduct utterly intolerable

in a civilized community, which negligently caused severe emotional distress to Plaintiff. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

65. The acts and conduct of the defendants were the direct and proximate cause of injury and damage to Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's statutory and common law rights as guaranteed Plaintiff by the laws and Constitution of the State of New York.

66. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

67. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

68. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

69. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Negligent Hiring, Retention, Training and Supervision

70. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

71. The City of New York and its employees, servants and/or agents acting within the scope of their employment did negligently hire, retain, train and supervise defendants,

individuals who were unfit for the performance of police duties on the aforementioned dates at the aforementioned locations.

72. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Failure to Intervene

73. The Plaintiff repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the foregoing paragraphs with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

74. The defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's Constitutional Rights had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

75. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein.

76. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, he was put in fear of his safety, and he was humiliated and subject to other physical constraints.

77. As a direct and proximate result of such acts, defendants deprived Plaintiff of his rights under the laws of the State of New York.

78. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

79. The City, as the employer of the officer defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

80. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries, including but not limited to emotional and psychological injuries.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Fourth and Fourteenth Amendment Rights:
Denial of Right to Fair Trial/Due Process

81. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

82. Defendants, individually and collectively, manufactured and/or withheld false evidence and forwarded this false evidence to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

83. Defendants filled out false and misleading police reports and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

84. Defendants signed false and misleading criminal court affidavits and forwarded them to prosecutors in the Kings County District Attorney's Office.

85. In withholding/creating false evidence against Plaintiff, and in providing/withholding information with respect thereto, Defendants violated Plaintiff's constitutional right to due process and fair trial under the New York State Constitution and under the Due Process Clause of the Fifth Amendment to the Constitution of the United States and to be free to deprivation of liberty under the Fourteenth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

86. As a result of the foregoing, Plaintiff sustained, inter alia, loss of the right to due process and a fair trial, loss of liberty, emotional distress, embarrassment and humiliation, and deprivation of his constitutional rights.

87. Defendants were at all times agents, servants, and employees acting within the scope of their employment by the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, which are therefore responsible for their conduct.

88. The City, as the employer of the officer Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoing under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

89. As a result of the aforementioned conduct of Defendants, Plaintiff sustained injuries including, but not limited to: economic, emotional and psychological injuries.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION **Malicious Prosecution**

90. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

91. The acts and conduct of the Defendants constitute malicious prosecution under the United States Constitution.

92. Defendants commenced and continued a criminal proceeding against Plaintiff.

93. There was actual malice and an absence of probable cause for the criminal proceeding against Plaintiff and for each of the charges for which they were prosecuted.

94. The prosecution and criminal proceedings terminated in Plaintiff's favor on the aforementioned dates.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION **Individual Defendant Officer's Failure to Intervene in Violation of Plaintiff's AC 8-802 Rights**

95. The Plaintiff repeats and realleges the foregoing paragraphs as if the same were fully set forth at length herein.

96. The acts of Defendant Officers constituted conduct under color of any law, ordinance, rule, regulation, custom or usage.

97. Defendant Officers had a duty to protect Plaintiff from violations of his rights under 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 802, to wit: to be secure in his person, house, papers, and effects against unreasonable searches and seizures, and to be secure against the use of excessive force regardless of whether such force is used in connection with a search or seizure.

98. The Defendants that did not physically touch Plaintiff but were present when other officers violated Plaintiff's AC 8-802 right against unreasonable search and seizure had an affirmative duty to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence by other officers.

99. Defendants failed to intervene to prevent the unlawful conduct described herein, thereby failed in their duty to intervene to protect Plaintiff from violation of his rights.

100. Defendant Officers, while in uniform, unlawfully seized and searched the Plaintiff, before detaining plaintiff and further causing his detention for approximately 8 days in total.

101. By reason of the acts and omissions by Defendants described above, Plaintiff has endured psychological and emotional injuries.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION
Violation of Article I, § 12 of the New York State Constitution

102. Plaintiff repeats, reiterates, and re-alleges each and every allegation contained in the above paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

103. Such conduct breached the protections guaranteed to plaintiff by the New York State Constitution, including but not limited to, Article 1, §§ 1, 6, 8, 9, 11, and 12, and including the following rights:

- i. freedom from unreasonable search and seizure of her person and property;
- ii. freedom from arrest without probable cause;
- iii. freedom from false imprisonment, that being wrongfully detained without good faith, reasonable suspicion, or legal justification, and of which wrongful detention plaintiff was aware and did not consent;
- iv. freedom from the lodging of false charges against him by police officers and prosecutors, including on information and belief, by some or all of the individual defendants; and
- v. freedom from deprivation of liberty without due process of law.

104. As a direct and proximate result of defendants' deprivations of Plaintiff's rights, privileges, and immunities guaranteed by the New York State Constitution, Plaintiff suffered physical, economic and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

105. As a result of the above tortious conduct, Plaintiff was caused to suffer physical, economic, and emotional injuries, as well as a deprivation of liberty.

106. As a result of the above unconstitutional conduct, the City of New York is liable for the conduct of the Individual Defendants and any damages they caused under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

JURY DEMAND

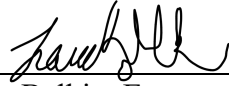
107. Plaintiff hereby demands trial by jury of all issues properly triable thereby.

PRAYER FOR RELIEF

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff Vantz Elianor demands judgment against the defendants on each cause of action in amounts to be determined upon the trial of this action which exceeds the

jurisdiction of lower courts, inclusive of punitive damages and attorneys' fees inclusive of costs and disbursements of this action, interest and such other relief as is appropriate under the law, and that the Plaintiff recover the cost of the suit herein, including reasonable attorney's fees pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988 and 2021 N.Y.C. Local Law No. 48, N.Y.C. Admin. Code §§ 8 – 801 *et seq.*

Dated: New York, New York
March 7, 2023

By: 
Lara Belkin, Esq.
Shulman-Hill, PLLC
Attorneys for Plaintiff
1 State Street Plaza
15th Floor
New York, New York 10004
(212) 203-1090

TO: THE CITY OF NEW YORK, Corporation Counsel, 100 Church Street, NY, NY 10007

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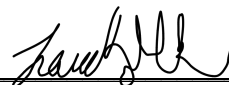
NYPD POLICE OFFICER JUNG SINGH, SHIELD NO. 30788, 81st Precinct, 30 Ralph
Avenue, Brooklyn, NY 11221

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

LARA BELKIN, an attorney duly admitted to practice before the Courts of the State of New York, affirms the following to be true under the penalties of perjury:

I am an associate of the law firm of **SHULMAN-HILL PLLC**, I have read the annexed **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief, as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my files. The reason this verification is made by me and not Plaintiff is because Plaintiff does not reside in the county wherein I maintain my office.

DATED: New York, New York
March 7, 2023



LARA BELKIN